



Recitation 5

Recitation overview

- Basic input and output ←
- Compilation – dealing with errors and warnings

Input and output

- C programs have two forms of output:
 - Exit status (integer return value of main)
 - Output printed to file / output stream
- C programs have two forms of input:
 - Command line arguments (list of strings)
 - Input read from file / `stdin`
- Today we will see output / input using `stdout` / `stdin`
- The function `printf()` prints to `stdout`
- The function `scanf()` reads from `stdin`
- Include `stdio.h` to use either of them

Output - the `printf` function

- The first argument is the control string
- The control string contains text and **conversion specifiers** (indicated by %) for injecting variable content
- For each conversion specifier in the control string, there is an additional argument (in order)

```
int i = 5;
printf ("Arithmetic operation:\n"); ← explicitly specify newline
printf ("%d + %d = ", 3, i);
printf ("%d\n", 3+i); ← any expression can be used
```

- `printf` has a variable number of parameters (uncommon in C)
- `printf` returns the length of the string it printed (including newline)

Conversion specifiers

<u>Specifier</u>	<u>Corresponding argument</u>
%c	Character
%d	Decimal integer
%e	Floating point – scientific notation
%f	Floating point
%lf	Long float (double)
%s	String

Defining field width

- With `printf()`, it is possible to define the field width for each of the printed arguments
- This is done by adding a number before the conversion specification. The value is aligned to the right and padded on the left with spaces.

```
printf ("Chars:%3c%3c%3c\n", 'a', 'b', 'c') ;  
printf ("Twelve:%6d\n", 12);  
printf ("Two thirds:%6.3f\n", (2.0 / 3));
```

```
Chars: a b c  
Twelve:  12  
Two thirds: 0.667
```

Defining field width

- Default is that the value is aligned to the right and padded to the left with spaces.
 - use '-' before the field width for left aligned printing
 - use '0' to pad the left with zeros

```
int a = 5, b = 12;  
  
printf ("%d,%d\n", a, b);  
printf ("%4d,%4d\n", a, b);  
printf ("% -4d,% -4d\n", a, b);  
printf ("%04d,%04d\n", a, b);
```

```
5,12  
  5, 12  
5  ,12  
0005,0012
```

Input - the `scanf` function

- The function `scanf()` reads from `stdin` and, like `printf()`, its first argument is a control string with conversion specifiers

```
scanf ("%d", &x);
```

- The symbol `'&'` is the address operator – the value read is written in the memory space of variable `x`.
- The `'%d'` tells `scanf()` to try to read an integer from the standard input
- `scanf` has a variable number of parameters
- `scanf` returns the number of values successfully read as input (should be number of arguments -1)

Input and output – example 1

```
#include <stdio.h>

int main() {

    int n1, n2; ← Variables should be defined at top of function
                  (unenforced convention)

    printf ("Input two integer numbers:");
    scanf ("%d%d", &n1, &n2);
    printf ("\nThe sum of the two numbers is:\n");
    printf ("%d+%d=%d\n", n1,n2,n1+n2);
    return 0;
}
```

code in `/share/recitations/recitation05/sum.c`

Input and output – example 1

```
#include <stdio.h>

int main() {

    int n1, n2, res;

    printf ("Input two integer numbers:");
    res=scanf ("%d%d", &n1, &n2);
    if(res<2) {
        printf("Wrong input. Expecting two integers.\n");
        return 1; ← Exit status ≠0 marks error
    }
    printf ("\nThe sum of the two numbers is:\n");
    printf ("%d+%d=%d\n", n1,n2,n1+n2);
    return 0;
}
```

Input and output – example 2

```
#include <stdio.h>

int main() {

    char    c1, c2;

    printf ("Input two characters:");
    scanf ("%c%c", &c1, &c2);
    printf ("\nThe data that you typed in:\n");
    printf ("%3c%3c\n", c1, c2);
    return 0;
}
```

- For characters – **scanf()** reads in sequence
- Other types – **scanf()** reads with white space separators
- Better to use file parsing functions, which we see later in the course.

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Your first C program

```
#include <stdio.h>

int main() {
    printf ("Hello, world!\n");
    return 0;
}
```

code in `/share/recitations/recitation05/hello.c`

- Compile this source file using `gcc`:

```
==> gcc -Wall -o hello hello.c
```

By convention, the executable typically has the same name as the C file, but without the `.c` extension

- Compilation produces an executable (`hello`) that we can run:

```
==> ./hello
```

```
Hello, world!
```

Dealing with compilation errors and warnings – cprog.c

- After we fixed the error and warnings
 - Add new line printing in the last printf for better printing
 - See what happens when we pipe 2 numbers in to the runnable program
 - See what happens when we insert floating point numbers
 - See what happens when we insert non-numeric values
 - Now you've realized that we need to check our input, so we'll use `(scanf("%d %d",&i,&j)==2)` to check if the scan was successful